

Speaker 2 [00:00:06] Now, yes, it has started for me.

Speaker 1 [00:00:07] So, just before we start the interview properly, I'm going to show you a document which is our consent form. This form is a document that I'll explain to you quickly, briefly, a few things. And then, you will give me authorization for the recording again because I need this to be registered too, right? Now starting for real, I'm just going to share. Here. Are you able to see everything? So, in the consent form, we briefly talk about it. Good morning! We are conducting an exploratory study called "A Multicultural Investigation on the Conceptualization and Measurement of Quality of Functioning," which seeks to understand what [Nationality] couples consider to be a good relationship. And there, if you agree to participate, further down, the interview should last about 40 minutes. It is totally voluntary. You can stop at any time if you no longer wish to participate. Here below, I have for you. You basically give me confirmation as you already have. I give my consent for the audio of the interview to be recorded, and further down, I agree with how your data will be shared. Basically, we have two options, and you can choose a third one if you prefer. The first option we offer is the full transcription, minus sensitive information from the interview that you will see later and that can be shared. The second option would be that transcribed excerpts can be shared, as long as you are not identified. Here it is not explicit, but in both options, you are basically anonymous. The only difference is that in the first option we remove what would be sensitive information from the interview if you don't want, and then you will see what those are throughout the interview. That's why I will ask you later as well. Can you hear that my cats are fighting here? I may have to change places, but I don't know if it was too noisy, but anyway, I can change places. But you have the first option, so just remove this information if you can see it and later you can even change the option. At the end of the interview, I will be able to tell you when it is the second option. Basically transcribe everything without removing anything. Do you have a preference for any?

Speaker 2 [00:02:36] No, you can transcribe everything.

Speaker 1 [00:02:37] Transcribe everything? Alright then. Just one more thing before we start for real, I would like to ask for your email because I need to send this document to you and then you send it back to me here, marking your consent option. The option you prefer and your signature below. So, I will send it to you after the interview. But it's good to write down your email now. If you want, you can tell me or send it via [Social Media].

Speaker 2 [00:03:05] [Email]

Speaker 1 [00:03:09] [Email].

Speaker 2 [00:03:09] [Email] That's it.

Speaker 1 [00:03:14] Ok, great. Got it. Thank you. I'll stop sharing this screen and start the interview. So, we have some basic questions about you first. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:03:35] [16-20].

Speaker 1 [00:03:37] [16-20]. How long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker 2 [00:03:41] [<1 year].

Speaker 1 [00:03:43] [<1 year]. Do you have children?

Speaker 2 No.

Speaker 1 Who do you live with?

Speaker 2 [00:03:51] With my parents and my brother.

Speaker 1 [00:03:54] What is your main source of income and your current occupation?

Speaker 2 [00:03:58] My parents, and I don't work.

Speaker 1 [00:04:01] Are you an [occupation]?

Speaker 2 [00:04:03] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:04:05] Well, before we start the questions about you and your relationship itself, how would you like me to refer to your partner? Girlfriend, wife, companion, by name, if you prefer.

Speaker 2 [00:04:20] Girlfriend is fine, it doesn't matter. Not wife yet.

Speaker 1 [00:04:22] Okay. Well, can you tell me your love story? Remember, you can give me as many details as you want. The more information you can bring, the better. So, no need to summarize much.

Speaker 2 [00:04:41] Let me think. We are in the same [degree program] course, so we met around mid-last year when we entered the university. But we weren't very close yet and such. Then our group of friends started getting closer, and we started getting closer as friends at first. There was no intention at first. Then a few months later, I think about two months after we were already friends, we started getting closer and I saw that maybe there was a chance there. She had never been with a girl before, so I had never imagined it, right? Then I started seeing that maybe something was going on there. Then we got closer, and we spent a month in this back and forth, back and forth, I was a little unsure about it, and I think she was too. And then, at a party, we kissed for the first time at the [degree program] party, and then we started seeing each other more. We went out a lot with our friends, and we got closer and closer. I don't know how to tell things in detail. Then at the end of the year, [Partner Name] came to talk to me and kind of put me on the spot. She asked: "So, where is this thing going?" I was still hesitant. I backed off. We went a long time without talking, I think about [1-5] months or [1-5 months], not sure. Then, when the university started again, I realized I didn't want to be without her. I went after her again, and then we stayed together without stopping this time.

Speaker 1 [00:07:00] I understand. How would you compare the quality of your relationship to your friends' relationships? From what you see?

Speaker 2 [00:07:13] Comparing my romantic relationship to my friends'?

Speaker 1 [00:07:16] The most current one compared to your friends' relationships, you know?

Speaker 2 [00:07:21] I understand. Man. I feel that we have a lot of openness, you know? Within our relationship, to talk about things. I feel very comfortable with her to talk about anything. Which sometimes doesn't happen in other relationships. I notice that. Sometimes my friends complain to me about something in their relationship that they don't feel comfortable with, and with [Partner's Name], we simply talk about things, you know? And we feel very comfortable. But I think the biggest difference I notice is that.

Speaker 1 [00:07:56] So, you would say that dialogue is very fundamental?

Speaker 2 [00:08:00] Yes, for sure.

Speaker 1 [00:08:01] Do you mind telling me how many romantic partners you have had?

Speaker 2 [00:08:12] Dating?

Speaker 1 [00:08:14] Romantic, it's up to your criteria. What you consider a romantic relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:08:20] Alright, I had [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:08:23] And how do you compare the quality of your current relationship with those two previous ones? And why?

Speaker 2 [00:08:35] Oh, much better. The stability, the confidence that if something is not right, we can simply solve it and talk about it. I never felt that before. I even say that I had relationships before, but I was the one who didn't truly connect. I think a lot of it is because of that.

Speaker 1 [00:08:58] I see. And for you, what makes a relationship have high quality and low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:09:12] I think understanding. Partnership, yes, makes a big difference. And understanding that the other person is also a person who will make mistakes sometimes, but that you are there to help each other. I think that's the main thing.

Speaker 1 [00:09:35] This is for high quality, and for low quality?

Speaker 2 For low quality. I think respect is very important. So, in a relationship that doesn't have respect, I don't see how it can work. And also, you. For example, not trying to understand that person as a whole. Yes, it would basically be that, you know.

Speaker 1 [00:10:24] And when you said that your relationship was respectful, you used the word respect as essential and trust. Can you give a concrete example?

Speaker 2 [00:10:47] I think it goes a lot with the decisions we make daily, you know? From the small things. So, for example, there are days when I want to go out, and she is feeling a bit down, and I want to do something. And we end up in a bit of a clash there. I think it's very much about stopping to think, knowing if it's really worth it. And thinking from her perspective too. For example, yesterday, [Partner's Name] was sick. Yesterday was our [<1 year] anniversary, and she was sick, had the flu, and such. I really wanted to do something to celebrate, but since she was sick, we couldn't, and we ended up staying home, taking care of her.

Speaker 1 [00:11:36] So, for you, what is most important in a relationship and why?

Speaker 2 [00:11:50] I think I'll repeat the answer.

Speaker 1 [00:11:52] I know you mentioned respect, dialogue and trust. Can you think of something else besides that?

Speaker 2 [00:12:03] Effort to be together and make it work. That is also very important. Sometimes we have to make some concessions.

Speaker 1 [00:12:13] Ah yes, yes. And for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:12:31] Wow. That is difficult. Admiration. Wanting to be together. And wanting to do good for that person. Knowing that the person makes you feel good. It's a mix of many things. Yes, the daily life and for me, also, it is the small things that express love. Shows of affection. Care.

Speaker 1 [00:13:08] Affection, right? That's it. And along with that, how important is love in a relationship for you too?

Speaker 2 [00:13:18] Very. If you don't love, it's much more difficult to maintain it, right? To maintain a relationship. And it's much easier to avoid it if there's no stronger feeling of pleasure. And it's precisely because of this base of care, affection, respect. Love greatly strengthens this feeling.

Speaker 1 [00:13:44] Just a detail when I asked what love is? Then you said wow, that's difficult! Every time I ask this, everyone says the same thing. There was a person I told that I know it's difficult to answer, and she said, but I don't think it's difficult.

Speaker 2 [00:13:58] When I saw here, when I said wow, that's difficult, I thought everyone must say this to you.

Speaker 1 [00:14:04] Right? I agree. And how do you know that [Partner's Name] loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:14:17] By talking too. Speech is very important. Also very much for what I said about daily life. The affection shown and the importance and preference she gives to me in her life and that she makes an effort. For example, she wants to do something with me, wants to see me that day. I think it goes a lot with making an effort. And that's when I notice the most.

Speaker 1 [00:14:53] And regarding conflict in your relationship, what would you say are the challenges you face in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:03] So, in our relationship specifically, there is a conflict that her parents don't know that we are dating, right? So sometimes we have some clashes because of that, her having to balance two lives, you know? We've had some arguments about that.

Speaker 1 [00:15:22] Hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:15:25] I think that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:15:28] I understand. And you and [Partner's Name]? Do you have disagreements, difficulties in the relationship besides that?

Speaker 2 [00:15:42] So, strong things that come to mind, no, just those small daily clashes, but we always talk and resolve them. So much so that I can't think of one. I think not. I can't bring one up.

Speaker 1 [00:16:01] Regarding those clashes you mentioned that you think are minor things that happen, how often do they happen?

Speaker 2 [00:16:14] I think it depends a lot on the context, you know? For example, [Partner's Name] is someone who takes care of her life a lot. I also like to make my own decisions, and when we have different opinions about how to handle something, we usually have a slight discussion about it. Two strong-willed women.

Speaker 1 [00:16:38] I understand.

Speaker 2 [00:16:42] Man, how often? I would say once a week to answer you a frequency?

Speaker 1 [00:16:49] An average, right? And what would you say these disagreements are about? The difference in opinion, as you mentioned.

Speaker 2 [00:17:02] Not directly the difference of opinions, but the difference in how to handle something, you know? I really like to resolve things right away. I get a bit anxious, so I want to resolve everything quickly. And [Partner's Name] sometimes wants to leave it for later and says calm down and such. And sometimes we have this difference.

Speaker 1 [00:17:25] And generally, how do you end up resolving this? More in your way or hers?

Speaker 2 [00:17:31] Depends on the context. Usually, one convinces the other. For example, now we are looking at tickets to travel and the price dropped, and I'm like "Wow, let's buy it now". Then she says, "No, let's wait, it might drop more." And I get nervous because of this. This is a concrete example. So, her inertia prevailed, because for her, buying a ticket is a bigger thing. I don't know if there is a prevalence of one of us.

Speaker 1 [00:18:09] And would you say there are other ways you use to maintain your relationship? Like this as a strategy to resolve conflicts, these divergences.

Speaker 2 [00:18:25] Man, I think a lot of it is showing affection, you know? Like, we may have a disagreement, but I continue to show affection. For example, sometimes I'm in the middle of an argument with her, and I want to stop and say, "Man, I don't want to fight anymore, I want to hug you" and that's a strategy to deal with these divergences.

Speaker 1 [00:18:55] And would you say the importance of dialogue too, that you mentioned this as well?

Speaker 2 [00:19:08] Yes, for sure.

Speaker 1 [00:19:08] Would you say that your relationship is good for you? Why?

Speaker 2 [00:19:08] Yes. I was even thinking about it yesterday. Like, I stopped to think about [Participant's Name] before the relationship, you know? A person sometimes much heavier and such, who worried a lot about things. Small things. And now, because of this certainty of relationship and love and such. And knowing that there is someone there who loves me and wants me to be well. And I think that's an extra comfort for me, you know? So, I'm dealing much more calmly with general life things. So, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:19:48] And do you believe that your relationship has changed something in you? And, if so, how?

Speaker 2 [00:19:59] Yes, I think a lot of this tranquility of knowing. Not despairing over things. I think about affection too. Before I had a lot of difficulty showing affection or even talking about things. And with [Partner's Name], I feel I can talk about things, you know? So, having this openness with her, I feel that at least I have an opening in some aspect of life. Yes. I think this dialogue we have made a big difference in me.

Speaker 1 [00:20:40] Yes. And do you believe that [Partner's Name] has changed too? Not only what you mentioned, that she, for example, worried more about small things. Are there other things you observe that have changed?

Speaker 2 [00:20:57] I think so. I don't know if I can answer for her, but... I think a lot of it too. She worries a lot about things, you know? And sometimes I don't. But I don't know if it would necessarily be something about changing something in her. And yes, our living together makes us see things differently, you know? Yes, she thinks one way, and I think another.

Speaker 1 [00:21:35] I understand. And do you feel secure in your relationship? What makes you feel secure?

Speaker 2 [00:21:51] Yes, for sure. I think it's my space of affection. Knowing that I have someone I can count on and talk about anything. It's my safe space, our relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:22:08] And would you say, for example, that showing affection would be an example of a sense of security?

Speaker 2 [00:22:14] Yes, showing affection. Talking about things that are bothering me in other aspects of life too. Because it is a safe space.

Speaker 1 [00:22:24] [Participant's Name], I'm just going to share the screen now because we have a part with some questions that need to be presented on a scale. It's very easy, I'll just share it here. Can you see it? So, we have this sentence: "My partner really listens to me." And we have a scale here from one, being not true at all, to nine, completely true. I would like you to tell me how much you agree with this statement and indicate a number.

Speaker 2 [00:23:13] Eight.

Speaker 1 [00:23:14] Eight. Same thing: "My partner cares about my needs." From one, being not true at all, to nine, completely true. Which would you indicate?

Speaker 2 [00:23:41] Nine.

Speaker 1 [00:23:14] Nine. For the sentence above that you indicated eight, can you explain why you chose eight?

Speaker 2 [00:23:41] In small situations, like the ones I mentioned about having some opinion clashes, sometimes I feel that she doesn't listen to me. For example, I say something, and she does another thing, while what I said could have helped, but she ignores it. I even say, "You don't listen to me."

Speaker 1 [00:24:03] Do you say that to her? And here below, the same thing. Why did you choose nine? If you can give me an example too.

Speaker 2 [00:24:19] A concrete example? I play [sport] and recently had some injuries. It was very difficult for me, and [Partner's Name] did everything to make me feel more comfortable, asking how I was. I had a competition to play, and she helped me take care of it, understanding that I needed to go to physiotherapy, acupuncture, various things. She always understood and asked if I needed anything.

Speaker 1 [00:24:57] I understand. I'll just stop sharing the screen, but I'll be right back. I'll ask you just two quick questions. If you feel comfortable, feel free to answer. Regarding your physical intimacy, the first question is: have you been having sex lately?

Speaker 2 [00:25:31] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:25:31] And how satisfied are you with your sex life and why do you think that is?

Speaker 2 [00:25:31] Very satisfied. I think we are having experiences that neither of us had before the relationship, discovering new things. It's been very good.

Speaker 1 [00:25:47] Cool. And just those two questions. The screen now, quickly. Is it showing for you? Well, in this part, we have the question "How satisfied are you with your relationship?" I wanted you to indicate which option best answers this question for you.

Speaker 2 [00:26:17] I will say very satisfied. Not completely, because thinking about the relationship in general, there is still the issue of her parents, which bothers me and is still a barrier. So, very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:26:33] Being very satisfied, placing it within this scale, how would you evaluate your satisfaction from zero, not satisfied at all, to ten, completely satisfied? Where would you indicate?

Speaker 2 [00:26:54] Nine.

Speaker 1 [00:26:57] So, nine?

Speaker 2 [00:27:18] No, put ten.

Speaker 1 [00:27:20] Ten, then. You answered ten, completely satisfied. Can you explain?

Speaker 2 [00:27:35] I think it's because I feel in a very light moment of my life, where I really want to be. I am very happy, and [Partner's Name] has a great responsibility for that. Our relationship has a great responsibility for that. It's something that makes me feel very good.

Speaker 1 [00:28:02] Cool. We are almost finishing the interview. I wrote down some words you said, summarizing: importance of dialogue, trust, stability, respect, effort from both to make it work, understanding, admiration for each other, comfort. I wanted to know if you want to add something, something I didn't ask, anything more?

Speaker 2 [00:28:40] I think these words are well... Well, I thought, but...

Speaker 1 [00:28:46] If you want to give a detail of the story, something you haven't given.

Speaker 2 [00:28:53] I'm very bad at this. I think [Partner's Name] was much better in the details. She's very good.

Speaker 1 [00:28:59] I understand.

Speaker 2 [00:29:01] I'm not. I'm bad at telling stories.

Speaker 1 [00:29:05] That's fine. Only if there was something to say. I wanted to thank you for participating and ask you again. Remember at the beginning I showed you two options for handling the information? If you want to change this option, you can. You chose the full transcription.

Speaker 2 [00:29:26] You can keep it.

Speaker 1 [00:29:29] Okay. Now that you had access to the more sensitive parts. So that's it. I wanted to thank you and also mention that this research is also being conducted in the Philippines, the Netherlands, France, and the United States.

Speaker 2 [00:29:46] Oh, cool.

Speaker 1 [00:29:47] It's quite extensive, with people from all over talking.

Speaker 2 [00:29:52] I see.

Speaker 1 [00:29:54] And I wanted to ask you a favor. Could you recommend one or two people I could talk to who could refer me to an LGBT couple or a non-monogamous couple? On my part, I only need to interview two more couples: one LGBT and one non-monogamous. And the non-monogamous is being harder to find.

Speaker 2 [00:30:24] I know an LGBT non-monogamous couple.

Speaker 1 [00:30:28] Oh, good!

Speaker 2 [00:30:31] But it would be a direct recommendation, right?

Speaker 1 [00:30:34] Yes, exactly. Can you think of someone who knows a non-monogamous LGBT couple as well?

Speaker 2 [00:30:45] My brother must know someone.

Speaker 1 [00:30:48] If you can give me his contact, it can be via [Social Media]. Then I'll talk to him. It would be easier to mention that you recommended me, so he knows who I am. If you don't mind.

Speaker 2 [00:31:01] I'll check with him if he knows someone. If not, I'll pass another person. I'll try to remember someone. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:31:13] If it doesn't work with him, you can send me the contact of the non-monogamous couple, depending on how difficult it is. I'll have to take the direct recommendation, but the ideal is not to. That's why I'm asking for a recommendation from someone.

Speaker 2 [00:31:31] I understand. Okay. Thank you so much. It was great!

Speaker 1 [00:31:37] Thank you! Good! I'll send you that document via email for you to send back with your signature. And I'll also wait for the recommendation on [Social Media]. Thank you, [Participant's Name]! Good morning! Thanks!